

Resume

Pacifique Liyana Ishimwe

Senior Product
Manager:Program & Product
Leader | Multi-Country Digital
Operations | Budget & Portfolio
Management

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Skills

SUMMARY| [portfolio](#)

Senior Product Manager with experience leading digital platforms serving millions of users across telecommunications, fintech, and energy sectors. Proven track record managing product roadmaps, coordinating cross-functional teams, and launching scalable digital services. Experienced in end-to-end product ownership including discovery, MVP development, platform optimization, and stakeholder alignment across engineering, design, and external partners.

Led the pilot and launch of an offline generative AI assistant deployed through voice and USSD channels, generating nearly 90,000 user queries during A/B testing

Skills

Product & Digital Leadership: End-to-end product ownership | Product strategy & roadmap planning | GTM strategy | Multi-stakeholder requirement gathering | Backlog & MVP development | Cross-functional alignment (Design, Engineering, QA, Business) | User research | UX/UI & prototyping | Data-driven decision making & product optimization (SQL) | AI product management | Risk & dependency management | Monitoring, evaluation & learning integration | Budget oversight & financial tracking

Delivery Frameworks & Operational Systems: Agile & structured delivery models | Participatory & human-centered design | Portfolio tracking & reporting | Performance measurement & analytics | Knowledge & workflow management | Continuous improvement through feedback & experimentation | Lean & user-centric design thinking

Tools & Methods: Linear | Jira | Asana | Confluence | Google Analytics | Tableau | Looker Studio | GitLab | Figma | Notion | PostHog | Agile/Scrum

Gassarro/ Founder, Product Lead

July 2025 – Present | Lusaka, Zambia (Hybrid)

Experience and outcomes:

- founded and oversee end-to-end operations, designing organizational structure, workflows.
- built CRM / business performance tracking systems for scale.
- Introduced KPIs and dashboards for real-time visibility; standardized core processes through SOPs; implemented automation to reduce operational friction.
- Leads and mentors cross-functional team, embedding clear ownership and accountability.

Impact: Strengthened execution discipline, reduced key-person dependency, operational delivery speed, and data-informed decision-making.

Opareta / Platform , Senior Product Manager (Contract)

April 2025 – July 2025 | Hybrid

Experience and Outcomes

- Led the development of a support tool for mobile money agents, migrating communication workflows from WhatsApp to the dedicated agent platform.
- Designed product requirements, user stories, and feature roadmap to improve agent efficiency and operational visibility.
- Coordinated engineering, QA, and operations teams to ensure smooth migration and adoption.

Impact: Reduced agent communication friction, improved operational tracking, and increased adoption of the new agent tool across the network

Viamo / Platform Manager

March 2023 - February 2025, Zambia

Experience and Outcomes

- Led a national digital engagement platform serving 2M+ users in sectors across health, agriculture, and civic education programs.
- Piloted and launched the world's first offline Generative AI assistant (Ask Viamo Anything), generating ~90,000 user queries during pilot.
- Co-designed large-scale IVR programs with USAID, CIMMYT, UNICEF, and government partners.
- Restructured engagement and revenue systems to improve sustainability, content partner and MNO partnership and scalability.

Impact: Sustained platform growth, improved financial performance, reached 50,000+ users
Monthly active users through programming, retention >75%

Brightlife by Finca / Product and Marketing manager

May 2022 - November 2022, Uganda

Experience and Outcomes

- Spearheaded expansion of digital and commercial offerings, launching bundled clean cookstoves and smartphones for low-income households
- Championed youth agent program, mobilizing 70+ agents for last-mile distribution
- Aligned cross-functional teams across engineering, sales, and external partners for regional market expansion

Impact: Three new products reached 5,000+ households, generating \$250K+ revenue; youth agent program increased partner engagement 40%; marketing efforts boosted digital product engagement 40%

Engie energy access /Senior Product Analyst &Product & Strategy Specialist

Oct 2020 - November 2022, Zambia

Experience and Outcomes

- Led product innovation and market expansion for PayGo solar solutions, focusing on off-grid accessibility and affordability
- launched bundled solar + satellite TV packages and piloted solar-powered irrigation for smallholder farmers , biogas digester cookstoves and x inverter-powered solar power systems.

Experience

Experience

- Developed and implemented CRM workflow migration, pricing strategy, and UX training library for the Zambian team

Impact: Expanded product reach, improved operational efficiency, achieved 100% adoption of CRM and training tools, reduced costs through budget tracking

UNZA (The University of Zambia /Bachelors of Social

Work| Focused in sustainable Development and the environment.

Mar 2013 - Nov 2017, Lusaka Zambia

COURSES:

Predictive Project Management course by the [Project Management Institute](#) (PMI)

Panelist, Africa SBS Workshop: Presented on innovative, offline-first digital solutions designed to drive social behavior change and foster digital inclusion among last-mile communities, highlighting the critical role of community-led co-design in ensuring adoption and impact.

- GDDF Panel Speaker: Piloted the world's first USSD Voice-Generative AI digital assistant that operates without internet access and shared insights on designing inclusive, offline AI solutions for last mile communities.

- Collaborative Case Studies: Partnering with GSMA and other organizations to document and lead a case study to share Impact stories of the Gen-AI initiative in Zambia published by GSMA: [GSMA report](#).

Available upon request.

Education , Thought
Leadership & Public
Engagement:

References: